

Paper Clip Story Solution Card Pack

Sixteen paper cards help writers shape fictional story solutions with clear needs, helpful choices, first steps, and revision prompts.

Audience: Families, co-op groups, tutors, and adult-led writing tables for writers ages 7-11.

Format: 16 printable solution cards plus adult guide tools, solution routines, take-home solution slips, and optional share prompts

Family-safe printable writing pages for adult-led, offline story practice.

\$57

Included

- 16 printable paper clip story solution cards
- Adult setup guide
- Fictional solution safety notes
- Paper clip solution coaching moves
- Privacy and family handoff notes
- Pack reset notes
- Six adult-led solution routines
- Ten take-home solution slips
- Eight optional share prompts
- Provider-ready PDF and ZIP artifact

Solution coaching

Before the session

- Print the solution cards, blank slips, and adult guide before the adult-led paper session.
- Use drawn paper clips or loose paper-clip shapes as story props, keeping every detail made-up and broad.
- Keep every solution fictional, broad, offline, printable, and guided by an adult.
- Choose a small stack so each writer works with one pretend problem and one fitting solution.
- Remind writers that a solution can be revised when the problem fit becomes clearer.

Paper clip solution setup

- Place a drawn paper clip at the center of the page with four labels: need, tool, step, result.
- Let the adult read the card and point to the label that should start the solution.
- Ask writers to invent one helper, one gentle problem clue, and one small solution step.
- Use blank slips for alternate fixes so crossed-out ideas stay low-pressure.
- Keep the paper clip broad: it can become a bridge, tag, pointer, clasp, handle, marker, or holder inside the story.

Story solution coaching

- Ask what the problem needs before asking what the helper should do.
- Keep the solution small enough for one character action and one visible result.
- If the solution gets too large, shrink it to one clue connected by the paper clip.
- Ask what changes after the first solution try so the next sentence has a purpose.
- Use gentle revision by swapping one vague fix for a clearer invented action.

Privacy and safety notes

- Use invented names, broad story labels, and pretend places only.
- Keep the activity paper-only, offline, and adult-led.
- Keep all details made-up and broad, using story labels instead of outside facts.
- If a detail sounds personal, replace it with a made-up paper-clip label or story object.
- Reading stays optional and limited to one fictional word, sketch, or line.

Family handoff

- Pass along one chosen solution slip and one blank slip for another fictional fix.
- Tell family adults to ask about the made-up problem and solution, not actual life details.
- Invite praise for one helpful clue, one fitting action, or one revised solution word.
- Keep the carry-along activity adult-led, offline, and paper-only.
- Ask family adults to leave narrow personal facts off the paper and keep the story invented.

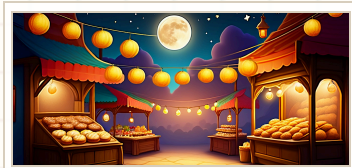
Reset

- Collect unused cards, blank slips, and paper-clip props.
- Recycle scratch paper that includes narrow real-world facts.
- Save only fictional examples that can model gentle solutions later.
- Restock the pack with fresh blank slips before the next paper session.

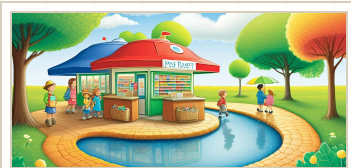
Use one paper clip solution card at a time. Keep every choice broad, invented, and screen-free.

Sixteen solution-card worlds

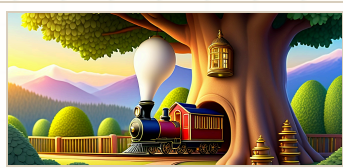
Pick a world image, then start one fictional story with a pretend paper clip solution card.



AGES 6-8
Moon Muffin Market



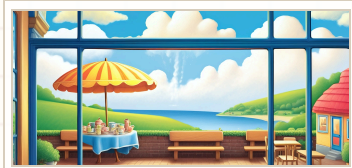
AGES 6-8
Puddle Planet Post Office



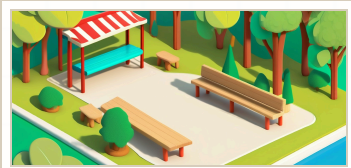
AGES 7-9
Buttonwood Library Train



AGES 7-9
Button Bakery Map Mix-Up



AGES 7-8
Teacup Town Weather Window



AGES 7-9
Pocket Park Notice Board



AGES 7-9
Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor



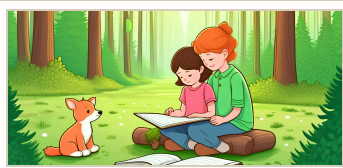
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Acorn Avenue Errand Office



AGES 8-10
Seed Library Map Room



AGES 8-10
Rain Gauge Railway



AGES 8-10
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AGES 8-10
Tidepool Timekeepers Lab



AGES 10-11
Revision River Ferry



AGES 10-11
Clue Label Tower Museum



AGES 10-11
Compass Craft Academy



AGES 10-11
Binding Day Boardwalk

Choose the paper clip solution rhythm

Clip Need Match Writers who need to connect a problem need to one useful action. 1. The adult names the pretend problem need from the card. 2. The writer chooses one paper-clip job: hold, point, join, or mark. 3. The adult asks how that job helps the made-up character take one step. 4. The writer writes one solution sentence that matches the need.	Tiny Fix Ladder Keeping solutions small enough for one short story scene. 1. The adult draws three small rungs on a paper slip. 2. The writer names a first try, a better try, and a result. 3. The adult asks which rung is the smallest useful solution. 4. The writer chooses that rung and adds one fictional clue.
Object Becomes Helper Writers who like solving through an invented story object. 1. The adult points to the drawn paper clip and asks what it could become in the story. 2. The writer chooses one safe make-believe object job. 3. The adult asks what problem clue the object touches or holds. 4. The writer writes how the object helps without solving everything at once.	Problem-Fit Check Testing whether a solution actually answers the card's problem. 1. The adult rereads the problem clue from the card. 2. The writer says which part of the solution matches that clue. 3. The adult asks what would still be unclear after the first try. 4. The writer revises one word so the solution fits better.
Kind Choice Swap Keeping a fictional solution gentle and cooperative. 1. The adult asks whether the first solution sounds too big, too sudden, or too bossy. 2. The writer chooses one gentler action word. 3. The adult asks how the new action still helps the made-up problem. 4. The writer swaps the action word and keeps the rest of the solution.	Result Then Revise Showing how a first solution can reveal the next clearer fix. 1. The writer writes one result after the first solution try. 2. The adult asks what clue the result reveals. 3. The writer circles one word that can become clearer. 4. The writer revises the solution with the new clue.

Start one story solution later

ONE PAPER PASS MISSING CLUE SOLUTION Clip the Missing Clue Invent a paper-clip solution that holds one missing clue in a made-up story: _____. Ask which clue the character notices first: _____.	BRIEF ADULT-LED PASS SMALL FIX Tiny Bridge Fix Write a fictional solution where a paper clip becomes a tiny bridge between two story clues: _____. Ask what the bridge helps connect: _____.
SINGLE PRINTABLE SLIP LABEL SOLUTION Helpful Label Create a made-up label that helps a character solve one gentle mix-up: _____. Ask which word on the label helps most: _____.	ONE PENCIL PASS FIRST SOLUTION TRY First Try Clip Write the first solution try a fictional helper makes with a pretend paper clip: _____. Ask what the first try teaches the helper: _____.
SHORT PAPER PASS MATCHING CLUES Two-Clue Match Invent two story clues and use a paper clip to show how they match: _____. Ask why those clues belong together: _____.	SINGLE CARD PASS RESULT AFTER SOLUTION Small Result Write what changes after a character tries one small solution: _____. Ask what new clue appears after the change: _____.
CALM STORY PASS KIND SOLUTION REVISION Gentler Action Replace a too-big fictional fix with one gentler paper-clip action: _____. Ask which action word feels clearer and kinder: _____.	QUIET PAPER PASS CLUE POINTER Pointer to the Clue Draw or name a paper clip pointer that shows where the solution clue belongs: _____. Ask what the pointer helps the reader notice: _____.
FRESH SLIP PASS PROBLEM FIT Better Fit Check whether a pretend solution fits the problem, then change one word so it fits better: _____. Ask which word made the solution match the problem: _____.	SECOND PENCIL PASS REVISE THE SOLUTION Second Solution Try Write a second solution try that is clearer than the first try: _____. Ask what the character learned before trying again: _____.

- Optional share prompts
- Optional adult-led offline prompt: my pretend solution is _____.
 - Optional adult-led offline prompt: the paper-clip object helps by _____.
 - Optional adult-led offline prompt: the problem clue I matched is _____.
 - Optional adult-led offline prompt: the helper's first solution try is _____.
 - Optional adult-led offline prompt: one gentle action word I used is _____.
 - Optional adult-led offline prompt: the result after the solution is _____.
 - Optional adult-led offline prompt: I made the solution clearer by changing _____.
 - Optional adult-led offline prompt: an adult can add one made-up clue here: _____.

Moon Muffin Paper Clip Crumb Bridge

Adult setup: Adult: Place this card beside blank paper and a drawn paper clip, then name one gentle market problem to solve: _____.

Write the tiny fix the moon muffin helper tries first: _____.



Moon Muffin Market

Solution step
Solution step: The moon muffin helper can gently solve the crumb mix-up by _____.

Place clue
Place clue: The moon-market counter shows this solution belongs here because _____.

Solution question
Solution question: What tiny fix keeps the moon muffin trade moving gently? _____.

Revise solution
Revise solution: Make the fix smaller and clearer by adding one moon-market clue: _____.

Character choice
Character choice: The helper chooses one small step, such as sorting, pointing, or asking, to _____.

Object use
Object use: The pretend paper clip becomes a crumb bridge, label holder, or moon tag that helps _____.

First step
First step: The helper tries the solution first by _____.

Quiet option: Draw the paper clip bridge first, then add one solution word: _____. **Take-home line:** Try another pretend market solution on blank paper: _____.

Puddle Planet Paper Clip Stamp Holder

Adult setup: Adult: Set out the printable card and invite one made-up puddle note with a blank stamp space: _____.

Choose the clue that helps the puddle mail helper sort the note gently: _____.



Puddle Planet Post Office

Solution step
Solution step: The puddle mail helper solves the missing clue by adding _____.

Place clue
Place clue: The puddle-mail counter shows this clue belongs here because _____.

Solution question
Solution question: Which clue should be clipped onto the puddle note first? _____.

Revise solution
Revise solution: Make the clue more puddle-like by adding one ripple, shell, or stamp detail: _____.

Character choice
Character choice: The helper chooses to check the note edge, stamp shape, or ripple tag to _____.

Object use
Object use: The pretend paper clip holds the stamp clue in place so the helper can _____.

First step
First step: The helper tests the solution first by _____.

Quiet option: Draw the stamp space first, then write the clue inside it: _____.

Take-home line: Make another pretend mail note and clip on one missing clue: _____.

Buttonwood Paper Clip Ticket Link

Adult setup: Adult: Put the card beside blank paper and ask for one pretend ticket need on the Buttonwood Library Train: _____.

Write the action that matches what the traveler needs next: _____.



Buttonwood Library Train

Solution step
Solution step: The traveler can solve the ticket mix-up by _____.

Place clue
Place clue: The library-train shelf stop shows the action fits because _____.

Solution question
Solution question: Which action best matches the traveler's need? _____.

Revise solution
Revise solution: Make the action fit better by naming one ticket clue: _____.

Character choice
Character choice: The traveler chooses one action that matches the need, then _____.

Object use
Object use: The pretend paper clip links a ticket, bookmark, or shelf tag to help _____.

First step
First step: The traveler tries the ticket-link solution by _____.

Quiet option: Draw two clipped tickets and choose the one that helps: _____. **Take-home line:** Try another pretend library-train solution by matching need to action: _____.

Button Bakery Clip Map Repair

Adult setup: Adult: Place this card beside a folded pretend map and ask what question the map-mender should answer first: _____.

Answer the bakery-map question with one paper-clip solution that fits the mix-up: _____.



Button Bakery Map Mix-Up

Solution step Solution step: The map-mender answers the crumb-map question by _____.	Character choice Character choice: The map-mender folds, labels, or turns one map piece to _____.
Place clue Place clue: The bakery-map corner shows the fix belongs here because _____.	Object use Object use: The pretend paper clip holds the map corner so the right clue can _____.
Solution question Solution question: What small fix answers the bakery-map question? _____.	First step First step: The map-mender tests the clipped corner by _____.
Revise solution Revise solution: Add one button, crumb, or fold detail that makes the fix clearer: _____.	

Quiet option: Copy the map question first, then write one answer word: _____. **Take-home line:** Use another pretend map problem and answer it with one small paper fix: _____.

Teacup Weather Clip Signal

Adult setup: Adult: Set out the card and choose two pretend weather clues that can be matched on paper: _____.

Write the solution that helps the teacup weather watcher match the clues: _____.



Teacup Town Weather Window

Solution step
Solution step: The weather watcher solves the mismatch by matching _____.

Place clue
Place clue: The teacup weather pane shows these clues belong together because _____.

Solution question
Solution question: Which two weather clues should be clipped together? _____.

Revise solution
Revise solution: Make the match clearer by changing one weather word: _____.

Character choice
Character choice: The watcher compares one pane clue with one cloud tag to _____.

Object use
Object use: The pretend paper clip joins the matching weather clues so the watcher can _____.

First step
First step: The watcher tests the match by _____.

Quiet option: Draw two weather symbols and clip the matching pair: _____. **Take-home line:** Try another pretend weather solution by matching two gentle clues: _____.

Pocket Park Clip Notice Fix

Adult setup: Adult: Set the card beside a blank pretend notice and ask for one small board problem to solve: _____.

Name the first solution try that helps the notice keeper move the story forward: _____.



Pocket Park Notice Board

Solution step Solution step: The notice keeper solves the board mix-up first by _____. _____	Character choice Character choice: The notice keeper pins, straightens, or labels one pretend notice to _____. _____
Place clue Place clue: The pocket-park board shows this first try makes sense because _____. _____	Object use Object use: The pretend paper clip holds one notice corner so the clue can _____. _____
Solution question Solution question: What first try helps the notice keeper move forward? _____. _____	First step First step: The notice keeper tests the solution by _____. _____
Revise solution Revise solution: Make the first try clearer by adding one notice-board clue: _____. _____	

Quiet option: Draw the notice corner and write one helpful verb: _____. **Take-home line:** Make another pretend notice-board solution with one clear first try: _____.

Spoon Ferry Clip Dock Helper

Adult setup: Adult: Print this card and invite one invented harbor problem that can be solved with a small paper step: _____.

Write how the spoon ferry helper makes the cracker dock easier to use: _____.



Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor

Solution step
Solution step: The spoon ferry helper steadies the pretend dock by _____.

Place clue
Place clue: The cracker dock shows this ferry fix belongs here because _____.

Solution question
Solution question: What small fix helps the ferry crossing continue gently? _____.

Revise solution
Revise solution: Make the harbor fix clearer by adding one cracker, napkin, or lid clue: _____.

Character choice
Character choice: The helper folds, slides, or labels one harbor detail to _____.

Object use
Object use: The pretend paper clip becomes a dock hook, flag holder, or tiny handle that helps _____.

First step
First step: The helper tests the dock solution by _____.

Quiet option: Draw the pretend dock and mark the helpful clip spot: _____.

Take-home line: Invent another spoon ferry solution using one paper-clip clue: _____.

Acorn Avenue Clip Sorter

Adult setup: Adult: Print this card and offer two pretend errand slips with invented labels, not real chores: _____.

Write the solution that matches each acorn slip to the right made-up helper: _____.



Acorn Avenue Errand Office

Solution step
Solution step: The leaf clerk solves the slip mix-up by _____.

Place clue
Place clue: The acorn counter shows this sorting solution works because _____.

Solution question
Solution question: Which slip should be clipped to which seed tag? _____.

Revise solution
Revise solution: Make the task match clearer by changing one invented slip clue: _____.

Character choice
Character choice: The helper sorts one slip by shape, seed mark, or tiny color clue to _____.

Object use
Object use: The pretend paper clip pairs each slip with its matching seed tag so the clerk can _____.

First step
First step: The clerk tests the paired slips by _____.

Quiet option: Draw two slips and clip the matching one to its tag: _____. **Take-home line:** Create another pretend acorn errand solution with no real chores: _____.

Seed Library Clip Symbol Match

Adult setup: Adult: Set this card beside a pretend seed map and choose one made-up shelf symbol to match: _____.

Write the solution that tells the map keeper which symbol belongs with the shelf clue: _____.



Seed Library Map Room

Solution step
Solution step: The map keeper solves the symbol mismatch by _____.

Place clue
Place clue: The seed-library shelf shows the symbol belongs here because _____.

Solution question
Solution question: Which map symbol should be clipped to the shelf clue? _____.

Revise solution
Revise solution: Replace a confusing symbol with one clearer fictional mark: _____.

Character choice
Character choice: The helper compares one seed pin, shelf card, or border mark to _____.

Object use
Object use: The pretend paper clip joins the matching symbol and shelf card so the keeper can _____.

First step
First step: The map keeper tests the match by _____.

Quiet option: Sketch one seed symbol and write what it matches: _____. **Take-home line:** Invent another seed-library solution by matching one symbol to one clue: _____.

Rain Gauge Railway Clip Signal Choice

Adult setup: Adult: Print this card and keep every signal invented, gentle, and paper-based: _____.

Write which pretend signal the rain-note conductor should use first: _____.



Rain Gauge Railway

Solution step
Solution step: The conductor solves the mixed signal by choosing _____.

Place clue
Place clue: The rain-gauge platform shows this signal helps because _____.

Solution question
Solution question: Which invented signal should the conductor try first? _____.

Revise solution
Revise solution: Make the signal choice clearer by adding one drizzle, glass, or flag detail: _____.

Character choice
Character choice: The conductor compares a gauge mark, cloud note, or flag card to _____.

Object use
Object use: The pretend paper clip holds the chosen signal card where the conductor can _____.

First step
First step: The conductor tests the chosen signal by _____.

Quiet option: Draw two signal cards and clip the one that fits: _____. **Take-home line:** Make another pretend railway solution with one helpful signal card: _____.

Moss Observatory Clip Word Patch

Adult setup: Adult: Print this card and ask for a pretend moss note with one missing story word: _____.

Write the solution word that helps the sky watcher understand the moss message: _____.



Moss Message Observatory

Solution step
Solution step: The sky watcher solves the message gap by adding _____.

Place clue
Place clue: The observatory note shows the added word belongs because _____.

Solution question
Solution question: Which word should be clipped into the moss message? _____.

Revise solution
Revise solution: Make the message word clearer by adding one moss, pebble, or lantern clue: _____.

Character choice
Character choice: The watcher checks one moss mark, pebble lens, or chart edge to _____.

Object use
Object use: The pretend paper clip patches the missing word onto the moss note so the watcher can _____.

First step
First step: The watcher tests the word patch by _____.

Quiet option: Copy the moss note and fill only the missing word: _____. **Take-home line:** Invent another moss-message solution by clipping on one helpful word: _____.

Tidepool Clock Clip Order

Adult setup: Adult: Set this card beside blank paper and invite three invented shell-clock steps to arrange: _____.

Write which tidepool solution step comes first, next, and last: _____.



Tidepool Timekeepers Lab

Solution step
Solution step: The tidepool timekeeper solves the order mix-up by _____.

Place clue
Place clue: The tidepool lab shows this order solves the problem because _____.

Solution question
Solution question: Which solution step should come first, next, and last? _____.

Revise solution
Revise solution: Make the order easier to follow by changing one shell-clock clue: _____.

Character choice
Character choice: The timekeeper tests one shell note, bead dial, or tide strip to _____.

Object use
Object use: The pretend paper clip holds the first solution step so the timekeeper can _____.

First step
First step: The timekeeper clips the first step in place by _____.

Quiet option: Number three pretend clues and clip the first one: _____. **Take-home line:** Invent another tidepool solution with three clear paper steps: _____.

Revision River Clip Target

Adult setup: Adult: Place this printable card near a drawn ferry note and ask which pretend solution detail needs clearer wording: _____.

Choose the solution target that needs one clearer word, then revise it on paper: _____.



Revision River Ferry

Solution step
Solution step: The ferry helper improves the solution by changing _____.

Place clue
Place clue: The revision ferry shows this target fits the problem because _____.

Solution question
Solution question: Which exact story part should the helper revise first? _____.

Revise solution
Revise solution: Turn the broad fix into one exact ferry action by adding _____.

Character choice
Character choice: The helper underlines one fuzzy solution word and replaces it with _____.

Object use
Object use: The pretend paper clip marks the solution target so the helper can _____.

First step
First step: The ferry helper tests the clearer target by _____.

Quiet option: Circle one fuzzy word and write its clearer replacement: _____. **Take-home line:** Choose one pretend ferry solution and revise one target word: _____.

Clue Label Tower Clip Pointer

Adult setup: Adult: Set out the paper card and invite one invented display label that needs a clearer pointer: _____.

Write the solution that moves the label toward the clue it should show: _____.



Clue Label Tower Museum

Solution step
Solution step: The clue keeper solves the label mix-up by _____.

Place clue
Place clue: The tower display shows this label solution works because _____.

Solution question
Solution question: Which clue should the label point toward next? _____.

Revise solution
Revise solution: Make the pointer more specific by adding one shape, color, or display clue: _____.

Character choice
Character choice: The clue keeper points, swaps, or rewrites one label to _____.

Object use
Object use: The pretend paper clip becomes a pointer that connects the label to _____.

First step
First step: The clue keeper tests the label pointer by _____.

Quiet option: Draw one label box and clip it to the clue word: _____. **Take-home line:** Invent another tower label solution with one clear paper pointer: _____.

Compass Craft Clip Choice

Adult setup: Adult: Place this card beside two invented compass choices and keep both choices broad and make-believe: _____.

Write which option helps the compass crafter move the story forward: _____.



Compass Craft Academy

Solution step
Solution step: The compass crafter solves the choice obstacle by picking _____.

Place clue
Place clue: The compass craft table shows this option helps because _____.

Solution question
Solution question: Which option helps the character move the story forward? _____.

Revise solution
Revise solution: Make the choice clearer by naming the two options and one reason:
_____.

Character choice
Character choice: The crafter tests one arrow, bead, or paper needle to _____.

Object use
Object use: The pretend paper clip marks the chosen option so the crafter can _____.

First step
First step: The compass crafter tests the chosen option by _____.

Quiet option: Mark option A or option B, then write one helpful reason: _____. **Take-home line:** Sketch two pretend compass choices and clip the one that helps: _____.

Binding Day Clip Promise Keeper

Adult setup: Adult: Set this card beside a pretend page clasp and invite one made-up promise that can be kept kindly: _____.

Write the small solution that helps the page helper keep the pretend promise: _____.



Binding Day Boardwalk

Solution step
Solution step: The page helper keeps the promise by _____.

Place clue
Place clue: The binding boardwalk shows this solution stays small because _____.

Solution question
Solution question: What kind step helps the helper keep the promise? _____.

Revise solution
Revise solution: Make the promise solution smaller and clearer by adding one page clue: _____.

Character choice
Character choice: The helper checks one sign, thread loop, or folded page to _____.

Object use
Object use: The pretend paper clip holds the promise note where the helper can _____.

First step
First step: The page helper tests the promise solution by _____.

Quiet option: Draw the promise note and write one helpful action: _____. **Take-home line:** Invent another small promise solution for a pretend boardwalk helper: _____.